

Professional SEO Checklist (50 Points)

Phase 1: Development (Before Writing Code)

1. Choose one canonical domain

Decide on one preferred version:

- <https://example.com>
- OR <https://www.example.com>

Do not let both compete.

2. Use HTTPS

Install SSL before launch

Never launch a production site over HTTP

3. Plan clean URLs

Good

[/services](#)

[/contact](#)

[/about](#)

[/blog/seo-guide](#)

Avoid

[/page?id=123](#)

[/index.php?page=1](#)

4. Create a logical site structure

Example

[Home](#)

→ [About](#)

→ [Services](#)

→ [Contact](#)

→ [Blog](#)

→ [Privacy Policy](#)

5. Plan internal linking

Every important page should be reachable within a few clicks

Phase 2: HTML Structure

6. Unique page title

Every page needs its own <title>

7. Meta description

Every page needs a meaningful description

8. Only one H1 per page

Correct

H1

H2

H2

H3

Avoid multiple unrelated H1 headings

9. Proper heading hierarchy

H1

H2

H3

Do not jump directly from H1 directly to H4

10. Semantic HTML

Use

<headers>

<nav>

<main>

<section>

<article>

<footer>

Instead of only <div> elements

Phase 3: Content

11. Original content

Avoid copying text from other sites

12. Sufficient content

Aim for at least a few hundred words on important pages where appropriate

13. Keyword naturally included

Do not stuff keyword

14. Answer user questions

Write for people first

15. Avoid duplicate content

Do not publish the same text on multiple pages

Phase 4: Images

16. Optimize image size

Compress images before uploading

17. Use descriptive filenames

Good

cardiology-clinic.jpg

Bad

IMG0003456.jpg

18. Add alt text

HTML

19. Use modern formats

Prefer WebP or AVIF where practical

20. Lazy-load images

HTML

Loading="lazy"

For non-critical images

Phase 5: Technical SEO

21. Robots.txt exists

Example

User-agent: *

Allow: /

Sitemap:

<https://example.com/sitemap.xml>

22. Sitemap.xml exists

Include every important page

23. Submit sitemap to Google Search Console

24. Canonical tag on every page

HTML

<link rel="canonical" href=<https://example.com/about>>

25. No broken links

Run a link checker before launch

Phase 6: Performance

26. Fast loading

Target a largest contentful paint (LCP) under 2.5 seconds

27. Optimize CSS

Remove unused CSS where possible

28. Minify JavaScript

29. Enable browser caching

30. Compress assets (Gzip/Brotli)